

주말에 뭐 했어요? 지난 일 말하기

Learn how to talk about the past politely with -았어요, -었어요, 했어요 and -(이)었어요.

WHAT THIS IS FOR



By the end, you can put verbs, adjectives and nouns into the polite past tense by choosing -았어요, -었어요, 했어요, -이었어요 or -였어요. You can also shorten vowel stems (가다 → 갔어요, 되다 → 됐어요) and fix three common spelling mistakes.

1 THE PATTERN

stem + 았어요 The last vowel of the stem is ㅏ or ㅑ.	Did / was (polite past)	어제 친구한테 꽃을 <u>받았어요</u> . I got flowers from a friend yesterday.
stem + 었어요 The last vowel of the stem is any other vowel (ㅓ, ㅕ, ㅗ, ㅛ, etc.).	Did / was (polite past)	그 영화는 정말 <u>재미있었어요</u> . That movie was really fun.
noun/word + 했어요 (하다 → 했어요) The verb or adjective ends in 하다.	Did / was (polite past)	주말에 방을 <u>청소했어요</u> . I cleaned my room on the weekend.
short form: 가 → 갔, 오 → 왔, 주 → 줬, 마시 → 마셨, 되 → 됐 The stem ends in a vowel with no final consonant. The stem and the ending join into one syllable.	Did / was (polite past)	어제 친구가 집에 <u>왔어요</u> . 같이 영화를 <u>봤어요</u> . A friend came to my place yesterday. We watched a movie together.
noun + 이었어요 / 였어요 Use 이었어요 after a final consonant (학생이었어요). Use 였어요 after a vowel (의사였어요).	Was (a noun) in the past	어제는 친구 <u>생일이었어요</u> . 파티 장소는 <u>카페였어요</u> . Yesterday was my friend's birthday. The party was at a café.

2 WATCH OUT

가았어요 (X) → 갔어요 (O): If the stem ends in ㅏ, don't add another 아. Just add ㅓ어요.

학생였어요 (X) → 학생이었어요 (O): 였어요 is only for nouns ending in a vowel. After a final consonant, use 이었어요.





됐어요 (X) → 되었습니다 (O): 되 + 었 becomes 됐, not 났. They sound the same, but 났 is always a spelling mistake.

3 YOUR TURN



MAKE THE PAST TENSE

Choose, write, or fix the past-tense form in each item, using the rules on page 1.

1

Choose the correct past form:

- ① 아침에 창문을 (닫았어요 / 닫었어요).
- ② 지난달에 한국어 책을 (읽었어요 / 읽었어요).
- ③ 어제는 날씨가 (좋았어요 / 좋었어요).

2

Answer in Korean. Use the past form of the words given:

- ① A: 어제 뭐 했어요? B: (공원에서 운동하다) ____
- ② A: 도서관은 어땠어요? B: (아주 조용하다) ____

3

Write the short (one-syllable) past form:

- ① 나오다: 지하철역에서 3번 출구로 ____.
- ② 배우다: 작년에 태권도를 ____.
- ③ 끓이다: 동생이 라면을 ____.

4

Fill in the blank with 이었어요 or 었어요:

- ① 어제는 일요일 ____.
- ② 그 사람은 제 고등학교 친구 ____.

5

Each sentence has one wrong word. Write the correct word:

- ① 동생이 올해 대학생이 됐어요.
- ② 어제는 피곤해서 일찍 자았어요.
- ③ 저는 작년까지 회사원이었어요.



ANSWERS

1) ① 닫았어요 ② 읽었어요 ③ 좋았어요

2) ① 공원에서 운동했어요. ② 아주 조용했어요.

3) ① 나왔어요 ② 배웠어요 ③ 끓였어요

4) ① 이었어요 (일요일이었어요) ② 었어요 (친구였어요)

5) ① 됐어요 (되었습니다) ② 잤어요
③ 회사원이었어요

